



Glass for Dubai Police

After expensive cars to pursue criminals, the Dubai Police will be getting Google Glasses <http://dgit.in/DubaiGGlass>



Insomniacs rejoice!

A sleep-inducing cap, Sleep Shepherd will make you fall asleep and help you in waking up too <http://dgit.in/SleepCap>

In conversation with Epson

He not only commands the deck at Epson, but possesses a rare trait to grasp technicalities and talk about them at great length. On his recent visit to India, we spoke to Minoru Usui, President & CEO, Seiko Epson Corporation, on a brand new printer technology that's helping Epson gain mileage, the death of print, and new challenges waiting in the wings. Excerpts:

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1 You're the person credited with Epson's micro piezo print head technology. What's the basic difference between this and other (thermal inkjet) printing technologies deployed by your competitors?

The biggest characteristic that differentiates our technology from others is that Micro Piezo doesn't use heat for ejecting ink. Because heat changes the nature of the ink, Epson printers can fire a much wider variety of inks – in principle we can fire any type of liquid from our printers.

This characteristic has helped us expand the application of printers from consumer use to business, commercial and industrial applications such as labels, outdoor signs and textiles that require special types of inks. A recent example of how we have been able to leverage the advantage of our Micro Piezo print head is in our hugely successful InkTank inkjet printers. Our micro piezo technology has allowed us to do away with expensive and inconvenient ink cartridges found in thermal inkjet printers. This is because Epson's Micro Piezo print head is built in to the printer whereas competitive thermal technology used in consumer printers are compelled to build the printhead into the cartridge. Our InkTank inkjet printers using Micro Piezo technology are changing the printing landscape completely with the lowest cost per print ever, the unique convenience of refilling ink and the reduced power consumption consequently reduces environmental impact.

2 Any disadvantages of the micro piezo print head technology?

You could say that it was technically



Minoru Usui
President & CEO, Seiko Epson Corporation

very difficult to create and manufacture. However, we have conquered all the technical difficulties as we have refined the technology over the years and recently launched PrecisionCore, which takes the technology to even higher levels. In terms of performance, we believe Micro Piezo has a lot of advantages over the competition.

3 Innovation is Epson's unique trait, with patented tech driving its core business offerings. And this is not just restricted to printers, right?

As you say, innovation is at the heart of all Epson products. We have very strong patents related to our core businesses. For example, we were ranked no. 1 or 2 for patents related to printers, projectors, quartz devices, and gyro sensors in Japan and US every year from 1994 to 2013.

4 How is Epson's smart glasses different from competition?

Epson's Moverio smart glasses are bin-

ocular and see-through. This means that in addition to offering the ability to enjoy big screen entertainment and acquire information from the internet they are especially suited to AR applications. This could be used for gaming or for a multitude of work applications.

5 Making printers is an art, I remember you saying at IFA couple of years ago. Why do you say that? And how is it an art?

We design our products with a strong belief that they should perfectly meet customer needs, and we go to a lot of effort to ensure that they solve genuine issues that our customers are facing. We sincerely hope that these products bring pleasure to our customers or help improve their work processes.

In addition, while many companies outsource manufacturing, Epson has a vertically integrated manufacturing system. We strongly believe in the Japanese concept of "monozukuri," which translates as "the art and science of manufacturing."

What this means is that we design and manufacture our products from the ground up, including the core devices at the heart of the products. This gives us control over the whole manufacturing process, and enables us to make ongoing improvements as we seek to create truly excellent products that exceed the expectations of our companies.

You can check out some ways in which Moverio can be used below:

Virtual guide: <http://dgit.in/bt200sg>

Opera subtitles: <http://dgit.in/bt200sds>

Disaster relief: <http://dgit.in/bt200drs> **1**

You can read the rest of the interview online at <http://dgit.in/epsonminoru>